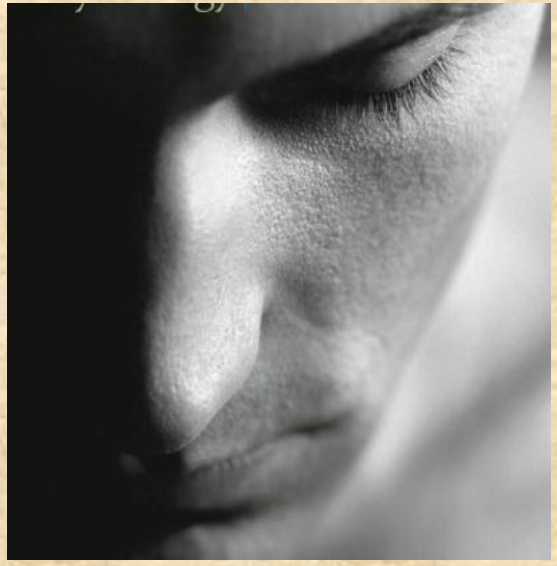
CHAPTER SEVEN

Psychological Disorders

And Treatment Techniques





The Nature of Psychological Disorders

- There are ***three*** main criteria's for PD
  - **Abnormality**
  - **Maladaptiveness and**
  - **Personal distress**

1. Abnormality – is a behavior that **deviates** from the **norm**

- Behaving in a culturally unacceptable way
  - **Violating the norm, standard, rules and regulations of the society**
  - **But deviated behavior only is not enough**

i.e. we should consider the context before deciding the person has PD

Cont …

2. Maladaptiveness – is a Psych. Disord. that creates a:

- Social, personal and occupational problem on the person
  - It disrupts the day to day activities and make life worse

3. Personal Distress: is a subjective feelings of anxiety, stress, tension and other **unpleasant emotions**

- The negative **emotions** arise due to:

  - The problem itself or

  - By events tha happen on us

What are the causes of psychological disorders?



Causes of Psychological disorders

1. The Biological perspective

- Believe PD occur due to abnormalities in **the brain**
  - Such as over activity of the neurotransmitter – dopamine
  - Due to excessive **presence of dopamine** receptors in the brain

    – linked to strange symptoms of schizophrenia

2. Psychological perspective:

- **The psychoanalytic view:** Freud believed that abnormality is caused by:
  - The **ego's inability to manage the conflict** between the opposing demands of the **id** and the **superego**.

Cont …

- Specially the individuals' *failure to manage:*
  - The conflicting of id's sexual impulses during childhood, and
  - Society's sexual morality to resolve the earlier childhood emotional conflicts

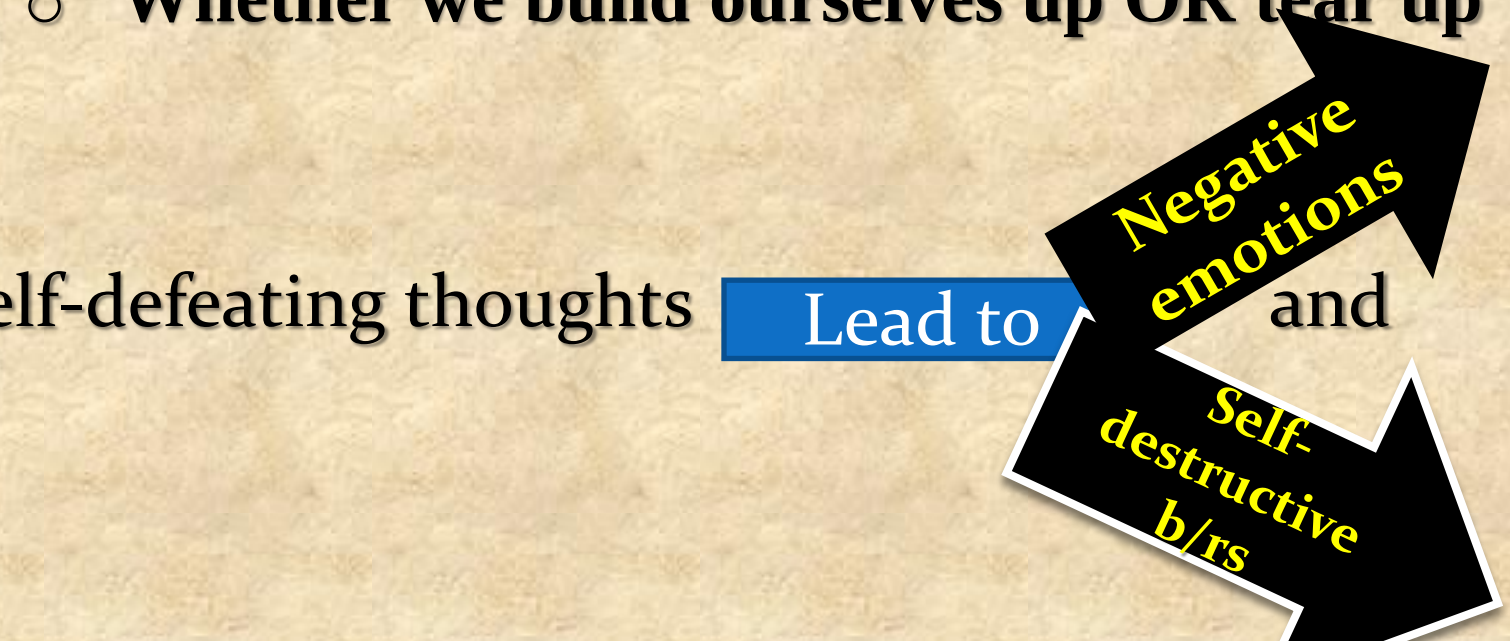
  } determine how to behave and think later

- **The Learning view:** believe mental & emotional disorders occur due to inappropriate or inadequate learning
- **The cognitive view**: People's ways of thinking about events in their life determines their **emotional** and **behavioral** patterns

Cont …

I.e Our thinking affects our emotional well being

- Either in the positive OR negative way
- It is largely dependent on our internal Dialogue i.e
  - **Whether we accept ourselves or not**
  - **Whether we build ourselves up OR tear up**



Types of Psychological Disorders

- Is characterized by abnormal thoughts, feelings, and behaviors
- Psychopathology is the study of psychological disorders, including their symptoms, etiology (i.e., their causes), and treatment

1. **Mood Disorders**: is a serious change in mood that causes disruption to life activities.



- It distorts your mood & interferes with your ability to function
  - **There is extreme sadness, depression OR happiness**

Types of Mood Disorders

- Mood disorders include: Major Depression, Dysthymic Disorder, Bipolar Disorder, and Cyclothymia.



  - **Major depression**: is characterized by
    - Depressed mood, diminished interest in activities previously enjoyed,
    - Weight disturbance, sleep disturbance,
    - Loss of energy, difficulty concentrating, and
    - Often includes feelings of hopelessness and thoughts of suicide.

Cont …



- **Dysthymia :**

  - a lesser but more persistent form of depression

    - Symptoms are similar with major depression except the degree is smaller
    - It is relatively steadier/regular than periodic



Cont …



- **Bipolar disorder/ Manic depression:**

  characterized by:

  - Periods of extreme highs (called mania) and
  - Extreme lows as in Major Depression
  - It is sub typed either I (extreme or hyper manic episodes) or II (moderate or hypomanic episodes)

- **Cyclothymia** : is considered a lesser form of Bipolar Disorder.

Cont …

2. Anxiety Disorders : - difficult to get through your day

- Nervousness, fear, sweating, rapid heart beat - symptoms

- Normal stress alerts us to dangers and help us to pay attention
  - It differs from stress in involving excessive fear or anxiety
  - Is the most common and affects 30% of adults in their lives
  - It affects us in our job performances, schools, and personal relationships



Cont …

- **The disorders in anxiety disorder include:**

a) Panic Disorder is characterized by :

- A series of **panic attacks/ intense feeling of fear** including:
  - Heart palpitations/ irregular beat,
  - Trembling, shortness of breath,
  - Chest pain, and dizziness.



- These symptoms are so severe that the person may actually believe he or she is having a heart attack.
- In fact, most are diagnosed by a physician in a hospital emergency room.

Cont …

b) Agoraphobia:

- literally means fear of the marketplace.
- The person fears places where a number of people are found such as:
  - Shopping centers,
  - Grocery stores, or
  - Other public place



- It is often a part of panic disorder if the panic attacks are severe enough to result in an avoidance of these types of places.

Cont …

c) Specific or Simple Phobia and Social Phobia:

- Represent an intense fear and



- Often an avoidance of a specific situation, person, place, or thing.
- For diagnosis:
  - The person must have suffered significant negative consequences of
    - **Fear** and
    - Must be **disruptive to their everyday life**

Cont …

d) Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder is characterized by :

- Obsessions (thoughts which seem uncontrollable) and
- Compulsions (behaviors which act to reduce the obsession)
- These obsessions and compulsions are disruptive to the person's everyday life,



- Hours being spent each day with repetitive thoughts,



Cont …

e) Post traumatic Stress Disorder (PTSD):

- Occurs only after a person is exposed to a life threatening event such as:
  - War trauma, natural disasters, major accidents, and severe child abuse
  - Once exposed to an incident, the disorder develops into an intense fear of related situations,
  - It results in reoccurring :
    - Nightmares,
    - Flashbacks, and
    - Heightened anxiety to the point of disrupting their everyday life.



Cont …

f) Generalized Anxiety Disorder:

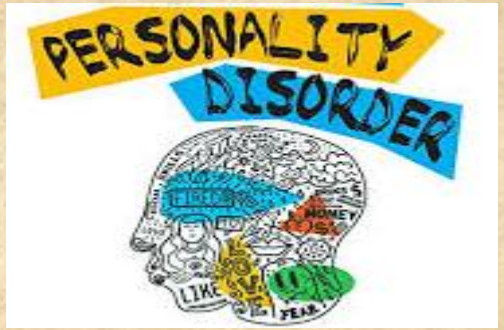
- Happens when a person has extreme anxiety in nearly every part of their life.



- It is not associated with just open places (as in agoraphobia), specific situations (as in specific phobia), or a traumatic event (as in PTSD).
- It is something enough to disrupt the person's everyday life

3. Personality Disorders

- It is when you have a **rigid** and **unhealthy** pattern of:
  - **Thinking,**
  - **Functioning and behaving**



- People with this disorder face problem with ***perceiving***, relating with ***situations*** & other people
- It is characterized by
  - Enduring pattern of thinking,
  - Feeling, and behaving

  significantly different from the person's culture that has negative consequences.

Cont …

- For diagnosis, the pattern must be longstanding & inflexible



- Types of Personality disorders:
  - *Paranoid* - includes a pattern of distrust and suspiciousness.
  - *Schizoid* - pattern of detachment from social norms and a restriction of emotions



  - *Schizotypal* - pattern of discomfort in close relationships and eccentric/odd thoughts and behaviors



Cont …

- *Antisocial* - pattern of disregard for the rights of others,



- violation of these rights and the failure to feel empathy



- *Borderline* - pattern of instability in personal relationships,

- Frequent bouts of clinginess/attachment and affection and resentment/anger,

- Often cycling between these two extremes rapidly

Cont …

- *Histrionic* –
  - Is pattern of excessive emotional behavior and attention seeking behavior and
  - Is marked by:



- Unstable emotions,

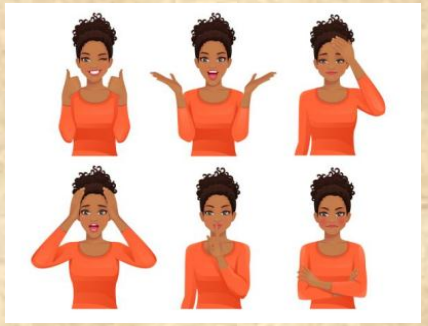
- A distorted self-image and

- Overwhelming desire to be noticed



Cont …

- **Narcissistic** - pattern of grandiosity/feeling



attractive, exaggerated self-worth and need for admiration

- ***Avoidant*** - pattern of feelings of social inadequacies,



- low self-esteem, and hypersensitivity to criticism

- ***Obsessive-Compulsive*** - pattern of obsessive



cleanliness, perfection, and control).

Treatment Techniques

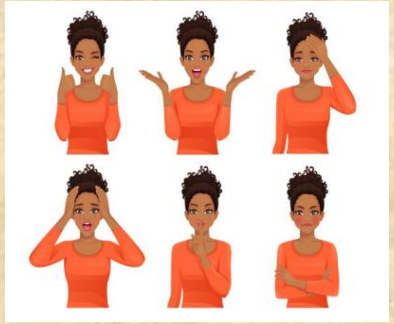


- Treatment can take:
  - Medication
  - Talk therapy or

  } a combination of both

- Psychotherapy consists of:





- A +ve r/nship b/n the client & therapist
- Mental health issues diagnosable or not
- Agreement on the basic goals of treatment
- Working together as a team

Factors included in talk therapy:



- Empathy: understand his or her client's feelings, thoughts, and behaviors
- Non-judgmental: you don't feel safe talking again
- **The branches include**:
  - Cognitive Model: look at dysfunctions and difficulties as arising from **irrational or faulty thinking**



- Faulty understanding of the world

AND

- Acting in a certain way

Cont …

- Behavioral Model: believe problems arise from learned behaviors
  - Achieved over years of reinforcement
- **Psychodynamic:** problems stem from issues beginning in the early child hood years

➢ **Treatment modalities involve**:

- Usually one – to – one – approach
- Is the most common one



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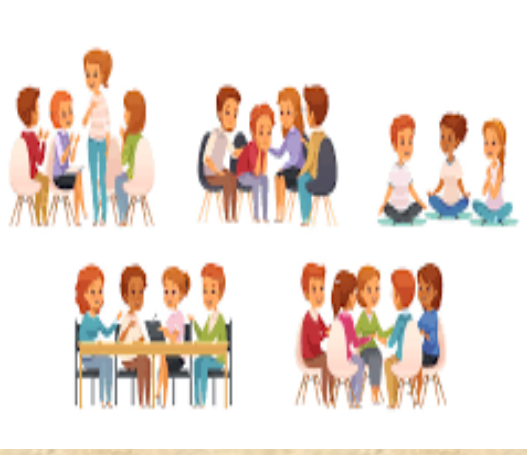
- Group – when individuals suffering from similar illnesses or



- Having similar issues

meet together

- Smaller groups: consisting couples or family



- Centered on relationship problems

- The counselor facilitates communication and

- Understanding, respect with in each other